



MARK ZUCKERBERG

Abilities: Speaks Greek, Fencing (origin of poking?), Making friends...ahem.

XP Points: 29 years old, 1 dollar salary, USD \$28 billion dollar net worth

Achievement Unlocked: Medal of Fear winner,

Quote: "The biggest risk is not taking any risk."

6 Did you know Facebook's colour is blue because Mark Zuckerberg is colour blind and can only see blue clearly? With books, news articles, business schools and even Hollywood script writers taking inspiration from the life and works of Zuckerberg, he's the anonymous friend - someone everyone is connected to but doesn't really know. Whether its on your computer or on your cell phone, the chances are that you've come across Zuckerberg's creation if not been a part of it. An innovation that created a whole new vocabulary for the world - friending, unfriending, poking and newsfeed have all found their way into interpersonal communication while at the same time changing the nature of interpersonal relationships. He has been a divisive figure in the world of technology, on one hand demonstrating true start up success with ruthless business skills and on the other hand an overwhelming supporter of education and social welfare. Mark Zuckerberg is one of the true innovators of this generation - the only thing that is left to wonder about him is what will he do next.

7 Ranked as one of the most powerful women in male infested world of Silicon Valley technology firms, Marissa Mayer has a pedigree that most professional would envy. She began her journey into engineering with excellence in the field of artificial intelligence throughout her academic career in Symbolic Systems and Computer Sciences at Stanford. Debuting her career at Google as the 20th employee and first female engineer, in her 13 years with the company she has worked on a wide range of them including Google Search, Images, Books, Toolbar and finally ending her tenure there as the Vice President of Local, Maps, and Location Services. So when she was hired as the CEO of Yahoo it was only natural that she would shake things up and she has, by overhauling Flickr, the company's file sharing service and acquiring Tumblr. And even as she continues to face criticism from many corners of the business world there is no doubt that her contributions at Yahoo are any less significant. Her focus on rebuilding Yahoo back to its former glory has already shown results with the stock price doubling over a year after her appointment.



MARISSA MAYER

Abilities: Artificial Intelligence development,

XP Points: 38 year old, USD \$300 million net worth,

Achievement Unlocked: First female engineer at Google,

Quote: "Geeks are people who love something so much that all the details matter."



NEERAJ ARORA

Abilities: Professional networker guru, Startup angel

XP Points: 35 year old, US Patent Holder - twice

Achievement Unlocked: New tech role model, Made WhatsApp available for ₹16/month plan.

Quote: "I'm generally a good guy."

8 The newest kid on the block, Neeraj Arora is an unknown. So new that he doesn't even have a Wikipedia page yet. But that's no big loss since you can find him on Google Scholar as a patent holder of "methods and systems for email attachment distribution and management and second for an email integrated file delivery". Not to mention that since he's just negotiated a deal that led to Facebook acquiring WhatsApp for over USD\$ 19 billion he's bound to move on to greater and bigger challenges. Technically designated as the Vice President of Business Development for Whatsapp, Arora is not just another IIT graduate making it big in Silicon Valley. With a degree in engineering from the premier institute and a MBA to boot, his career was set with a job in Corporate Development for Google before he decided to risk it all in an unknown startup in 2011. That startup is now known and beloved by over 450 million people as the ever popular WhatsApp messaging app. And Neeraj Arora is now a household name.



RUZWANA BASHIR

Abilities: Adventure travel, Mountain climbing,

XP Points: 30 year old, Google protege, experienced travel in 40 countries - priceless.

Achievement Unlocked: Climbed Mount Kilimanjaro, Build schools in rural Tanzania, Fulbright Scholar

Quote: "If you are going to start something, try to work at a startup first."

9 It's apparent that there are more women in board rooms than in computer labs where the real innovation happens. But as the playing field levels we expect to see more Sheryl Sandbergs and Marissa Mayers behind the computer as well the board room table. One such emerging stars to look out for is Ruzwana Bashir. The next generation of innovative startups will come from unexpected places; emerging economies and women, and Bashir is a potent combination of both. A prodigious mind, the 30 year old started off exceptionally with a degree from Oxford where she read Philosophy, Politics and Economics and was became the first Asian woman elected as the President of the Oxford Union. She went on to Harvard as a Fulbright Scholar all the while pursuing her greatest passion - travel. She leveraged that passion and started Peek.com - a travel company, that is slowly conquering the USD\$ 27 billion dollar industry. Already she has impressed Silicon Valley luminaries such as Google Chairman Eric Schmidt, who's officially her mentor and Twitter co-founder Jack Dorsey, both of whom have invested in her and her ideas. As one of the most promising figures in the industry she's already been called the "Queen of the Valley" making moves to conquer the world.



TRACY CHOU

Abilities: Python, Distributed Systems and Data Driven Design, Pinterest

XP Points: 29 year old, True Girl Geek, 14,200+ Pins, 157,000+ followers

Achievement Unlocked: Rejected all the old guards of Silicon Valley, Collection of prettiest pics on Pinterest

Quote: "There's a lot of opportunity ahead. It's a little bit frightening and exciting at the same time."

10 It would be easy to call Tracy Chou a ninja in the world of software engineering. But it's an undeniable fact that Chou is one of the next big minds of the industry. Only a few years ago, Chou graduated from Stanford where she was awarded a B.Sc in Electrical Engineering and a M.Sc in Computer Science. After the prestigious Mayfield fellows program and much vied for internships at places like Google and Facebook she made a counter-intuitive decision to start small. Instead of accepting offers from her internship employers and other big brands, she chose Quora. She was the second engineer and 15th employee hired by the industry infant in 2010 and after just over a year of exceptional performance was poached by Pinterest to focus on product development, platform and infrastructure design. Having completed just over two years at Pinterest and a wealth of rich experience behind her, its only a question of "when" and not "if" she is going to start her own company in the valley. We just have to wait to see how she solves the world's problems through technology.